AI Tool Selection Guide for Engineering Work

Choose the right tool for each task type

Chat Interfaces (Claude.ai, ChatGPT, Gemini)

Q&A and drafting
Projects and files
Search, code, images
Brainstorming

Flexible, conversational
Good for exploration
Easy to iterate

NotebookLM (Google)

Research synthesis
Source−grounded answers
Podcast generation
Multi−document analysis

Cites sources directly
Reduces hallucination
Great for learning

Coding Agents (Claude Code, etc.)

Multi−step tasks
File operations
Runs code and tests
Technical implementation

Edits real files
Runs commands
Project−aware context

Browser Extensions (Claude, etc.)

Web page analysis
Quick questions
Content summarization
In−context assistance

Works in browser
No context switching
Immediate access